



BDM Capstone Project

Title:

**Integrated Management Solutions for Durga
Traders' Challenges**

Submitted by:

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Declaration statement

I am working on a Project titled “Integrated Management Solutions for Durga Traders’ Challenges”. I extend my appreciation to Durga Traders, for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered through primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

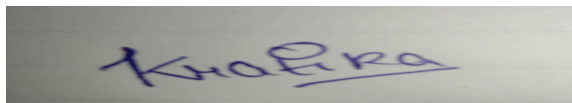
Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis has been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the information of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I agree that all the recommendations are business-specific and limited to this project exclusively, and cannot be utilised for any other purpose with an IIT Madras tag. I understand that IIT Madras does not endorse this.

Signature of the candidate :



Name : Kratika Varshney

Date : 3rd of November 2024

Executive Summary

Durga Traders, a well established B2B enterprise based in Aligarh, has been one of the leading distributors of quality coals for over two decades. It specialises in supplying coal to depots of various cities.

The pricing volatility due to fluctuating market conditions, which makes it difficult to maintain stable prices and secure predictable revenue. Additionally, quality assurance is an ongoing concern, as Durga must source reliable, high-grade coal to meet client standards and avoid quality-related complaints. Finally, financial stability remains a challenge as the firm must carefully manage cash flow, inventory costs, and credit risk to remain profitable amidst market uncertainties.

To identify a solution, I will employ both qualitative and quantitative research methods. Qualitative data will be gathered through discussions with the firm owner to uncover any underlying issues that may be affecting the performance. Quantitative data will be collected from the past years to provide reliable and objective insights that can be used to understand important statistics. By combining qualitative and quantitative data, I aim to develop a comprehensive understanding of the business and provide valuable recommendations to improve revenue and stabilise growth.

Organisation Background

Durga Traders is a prominent firm based in Aligarh (Uttar Pradesh), whose proprietor is Mr. Porush Gupta, specialising in the supply of high-quality steam coal, coal dust, Foundry Coke, Hard coke, Wood charcoal. The firm sources coal from regions like West Bengal, Haldia, and Orissa, ensuring a reliable supply of high-quality coal to meet the needs of industrial clients. Durga Traders supplies coal to depots in key cities, including Meerut, Moradabad, Aligarh, Mathura, and Lucknow, as well as extending its services to clients in other states.

In the past two years, the firm obtained its GST number, before that it worked locally with the depots of various cities. Also the firm has taken business loans from banks to expand their business. When i spoke to Mr. Porush to discuss their business, he elaborated on specific areas where my assistance could potentially make a difference.

Problem Statement

After an extensive conversation with Mr. Porush Gupta, I identified the following problems:

- The firm faces financial instability which complicates operations with cash flow management and credit risk.
- There is pricing volatility making it difficult to offer stable rates and maintain reliable profit margins.
- Ensuring consistent coal quality concerns that damage client trust and satisfaction.

Background of the problem

Once I identified the problems(as stated above), it was clear for me that the problem is caused by various external and internal factors.

- The reason behind the quality issues might be that the Durga Traders relies on multiple suppliers, making quality consistency a challenge.
- As coal prices are highly susceptible to market fluctuations like international demand, regulatory policies, and seasonal changes, For Durga Traders, this price volatility impacts their ability to offer stable rates to clients.
- Using the ledgers, we can speculate about the various problems. We predict the reason for the financial instability might be the credit and debit rate which affects their financial stability a lot.

The owner also seems to be reluctant to stop giving credit to customers as most of his customers pay for their stock after they purchase it.

Problem Solving Approach

Quantitative analysis

We need to integrate all ledgers, bills, and transaction records into one common spreadsheet. This will allow us to see the bigger picture and identify patterns and abnormalities.

Qualitative analysis

This will include conducting interviews with the owner to gather information about the materials which are in high demand, the factors that drive sales, and the factors that impede sales. This will provide the study with an understanding of the business ground reality.

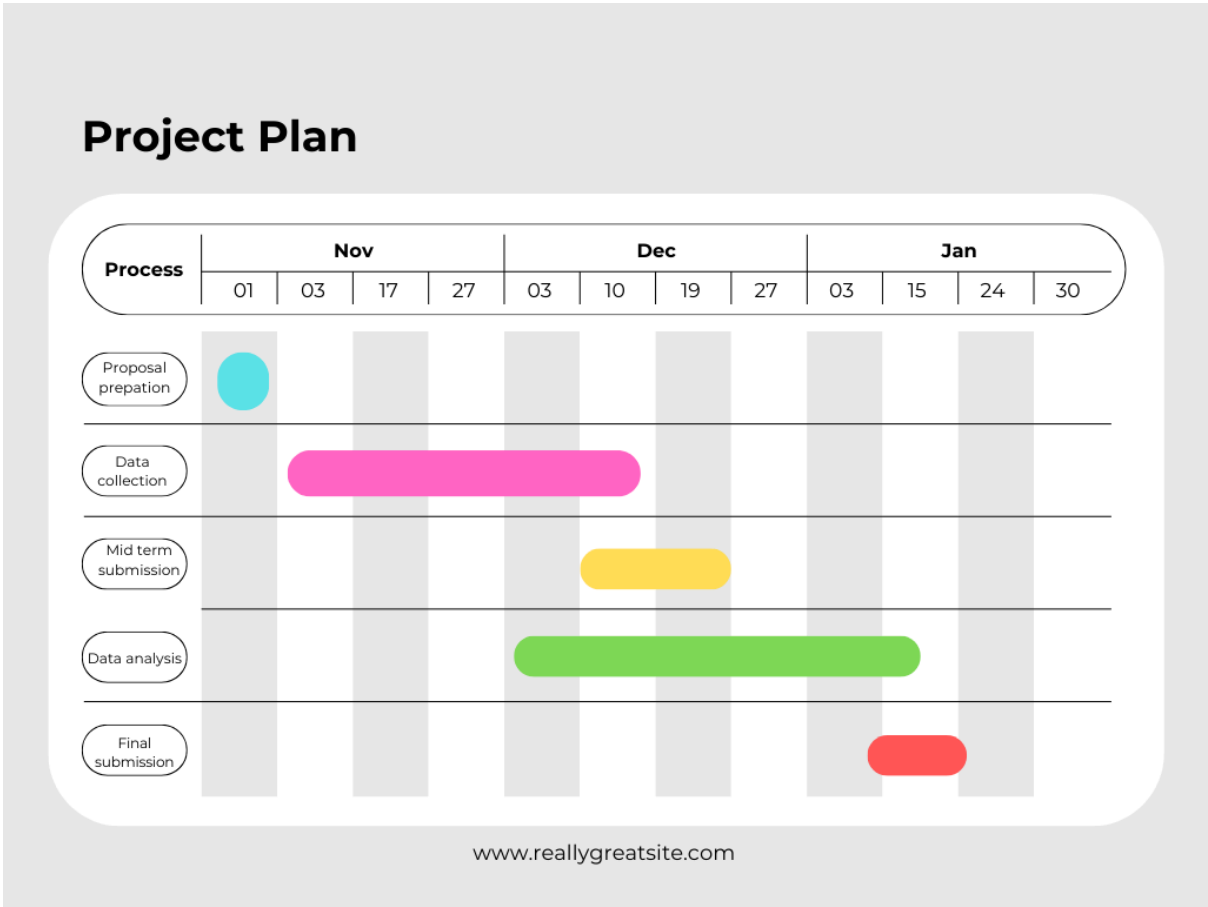
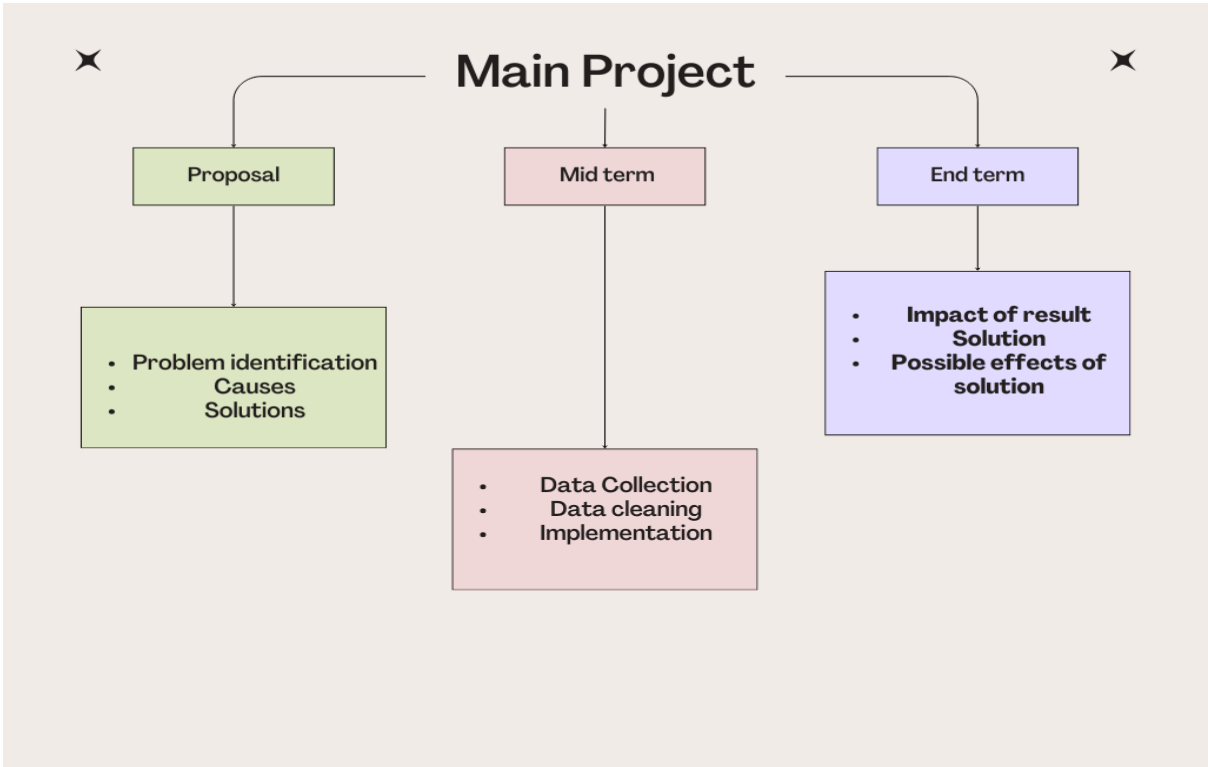
Problem identification

Leveraging clear trends and data, we can gain a deeper understanding of the root causes, be they market conditions, economic factors, or external process inefficiencies.

Intended data collection: Through the company's ledgers, I will collect detailed information about the sales performance. This information will be utilised to gain an in-depth understanding of the business's statistics. Additionally the qualitative analysis will provide further insights that will complement the quantitative analysis.

Tools used: The analysis of the data will be conducted through Microsoft Excel, leveraging its diverse functions and features. Tools like pivot tables will be particularly advantageous for organising and summarising our transactional data effectively. Additionally, visual representations such as bar graphs and pie charts will help us visualise the data.

Expected timeline



Expected Outcome

- Applying theoretical knowledge to real world problems, bringing gap between textbook learning and practical application using tools like Excel and Google Sheets.
- Use data visualisation techniques to enhance comprehension of complex data sets, enabling clearer understanding of findings for better policy implementation.
- Develop and implement policies on data insights, ensuring that solutions are grounded in real world evidence and addressing specific problems identified through data analysis.